CalFresh Cost-of-Living Adjustments (COLA) for Federal Fiscal Year (FFY) 2023 Effective 10/01/2022	Number	Page
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Effective Date:
10/01/2022

Background:
The COLA adjustments are effective every year on the **first day of October**. For Semi-Annual Reporting (SAR) households (HH) where October falls mid-period, the COLA is treated as a county initiated mid period change.

Purpose:
This notice provides staff with an overview of the COLA changes and instructions for implementation.

Policy:
The COLA mass update ran on September 10th, 2022. The Scratch Budget has been updated to reflect the new amounts. The following changes are part of the FFY 2023 COLA:

Item	Change
Maximum Allotments	Increased and can be found on the Assistance Standards Tables (63-1101)
Minimum Allotment	Increased to $23 for a HH of 1 or 2
Income Eligibility Standards	Increased and can be found on the Assistance Standards Tables
Shelter Deduction	Increased from $597 to $624
Standard Deduction	Increased as follows: Eligible HH Size: Standard Deduction 1-4: $193 5: 225 6 or more: 258
Homeless HH Shelter Allowance	Increased from $159.73 to $167
Standard Utility Allowance (SUA)	Increased from $487 to $560
Limited Utility Allowance (LUA)	Increased from $144 to $150
Telephone Utility Allowance (TUA)	Decreased from $19 to $18
Reminder: The LUA and TUA are only to be used to determine eligibility to Expedited Services (63-105).	

The following resource limits have been updated as part of the FFY 2023 COLA:
- $4,250 for HH that include an elderly or disabled (E/D) member, and
- $2,750 for all other HHs.

Notices:
Timely notice is not required when processing a mass change. The Notice to All CalFresh Recipients (CF 11) will be made available in the Electronic Forms Library (EFL) for customers that have questions about COLA.

COLA informing posters are required to be displayed in areas frequented by customers at Family Resource Centers (FRCs). Posters must remain on display from October 1, 2022, until November 30, 2022. The COLA informing posters are attached to this letter.

Management Reporting:
The following COLA Supplemental Reports require action and can be found on the EO Tracking SharePoint:

REPORT	CONTENT	ACTION REQUIRED
Mass Update COLA Exception Report	Description of errors encountered on cases during the batch run process, that were not auto authorized.	Review case and authorize.
Client Correspondence Details Report	Client Correspondence triggered during the CalFresh COLA run.	1. Review all correspondence that is held in the Print Queue. 2. Delete unnecessary correspondence. 3. Before mailing required correspondence, complete manual variables.

References:
CalFresh Cost of Living Adjustments
All County Letter 22-39
MPP 63-1100 Eligibility Determination
Scratch Budget – Eligibility Operations Desk Aid
Management Reports – EO Tracking SharePoint

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 09/30/2023.

Approval for Release:

Assmaa Elayyat, Chief
Self-Sufficiency Services